

Russell Dudek

PROCESS EXCELLENCE, AUTOMATION & ENTERPRISE OPERATING SYSTEMS LEADER



Russell Dudek

Pittsburgh, PA · Planning relocation to Tampa/St. Petersburg
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russelldudek.github.io/USAA/

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Operator-technologist who turns complex work into visible, governed operating systems. Brings director-level leadership across process engineering, automation opportunity design, high-reliability controls, high-volume operations, cross-functional transformation, and team development.

ROLE-ALIGNED VALUE

- Portfolio leadership:** Connects member and employee outcomes to process truth, platform fit, risk, adoption, and measurable value.
- Process excellence:** Builds standard work, root-cause practice, performance measures, decision rights, and control evidence that teams can use.
- Automation adoption:** Places AI and automation inside real workflows with human authority, evaluation, escalation, coaching, and accountable ownership.

CANDIDATE THESIS

Scale the workflow and its assurance together.

Automation earns scale when member/employee outcomes and ownership/control evidence improve as one system.

CREDENTIALS

Google AI Essentials
IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
Six Sigma Certification
OSHA 10

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Agentic AI · LLM workflows · RAG · Human-in-the-loop design · Python · SQL · JavaScript · TensorFlow · Tableau · Odoo · Jira · Confluence · HubSpot · Slack

EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet 2025 - Present

Director of Operations

- Leads AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Works in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

DudeWorth 2017 - Present

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks that assess value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.

Amazon 2014 - 2018

Operations Management / Site Leader

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward operating environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms.
- Applied Lean and Gemba practices across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and team engagement.

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EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Compunetics

2000 - 2013

Director of Operations and Engineering Management

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD; published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

Cardinal Building Products

2021 - 2023

Regional Director

- Built the company's first remote regional operation.
- Modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

ZeusVu

2018 - 2022

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

ROLE-RELEVANT OPERATING MECHANISMS

Portfolio selection: Value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.

Assurance by design: Human authority, escalation, decision records, evaluation, controls, and monitoring.

Operating cadence: Visible measures, leader routines, standard work, coaching, and escalation.

Signal-to-action: Factory, field, customer, and machine signals translated into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, and cleaner handoffs.

ADDITIONAL LEADERSHIP

Enviro Social Capital - Chairman of the Board, 2014-2017

Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative; helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh green-infrastructure improvement.

IEEE - CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair, 2012-2016

Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.

EDUCATION AND LOCATION

University of Pittsburgh

Bachelor of Science

Location: Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. Planning relocation to the Tampa/St. Petersburg region; recognizes USAA's four-day in-office requirement and absence of relocation assistance.

Candidate vision: russelldudek.github.io/USAA/